

**P Shilu Ao** was a Naga political leader who played a significant role in the creation of Nagaland in 1963. Under the British, the various Naga tribes had retained a degree of control over their own region and affairs. With the coming of Indian independence, some Nagas sought to create an independent Naga nation, and engaged in a violent, bloody conflict with India. In the 1960s, more moderate Nagas like Dr Imkongliba Ao and P Shilu Ao chose instead to negotiate with the Indian government for a separate state for the Nagas within India. Ao was elected the newly created state's first chief minister.

## LALDENGA

1927–1990